

GOUVERNEMENT DE LA
REPUBLIQUE DE VANUATU

SECRETARIAT DU COMMISSION DE
LA FONCTION PUBLIQUE

Sac Postal Privé 9017, PORT VILA
Tel: 33360/5333800



GOVERNMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF VANUATU

PUBLIC SERVICE
COMMISSION SECRETARIAT

Private Mail Bag 9017, PORT VILA
Tel: 33360/5333800

*Toutes correspondances doivent être adressées au SECRÉTAIRE, Bureau de la Commission de la Fonction Publique.
All correspondences should be addressed to the SECRETARY, Office of the Public Service Commission.*

PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION OF VANUATU

GUIDELINES FOR PREPARING HALF YEARLY REPORTS IN THE VANUATU PUBLIC SERVICE

2021

Foreword

The revised *Guidelines for Preparing Half Yearly Reports in the Vanuatu Public Service* have been prepared by the Public Service Commission with the assistance of the Workplace Innovation Team (WIT) to support Public Sector Reform – particularly in the areas of institutional improvements and innovation in the Vanuatu Public Service. Consultations have also been held with the Department of Strategic Policy, Planning and Aid Coordination (DSPPAC) and the Ministry of Finance and Economic Management (MFEM).

To track delivery, identify slippage due to emerging priorities such as a national disaster and to allow for review of Business Plans, a Half Yearly Report is required to be prepared for the period January to June annually and submitted to Sector Analysts and the Monitoring and Evaluation Unit of the Department of Sectoral Policy, Planning & Aid Coordination (DSPPAC).

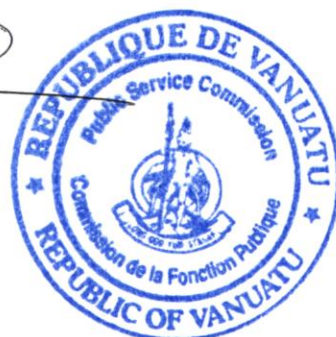
In addition, DSPPAC requests each Ministry to provide a quarterly narrative report against the Program Narratives as presented to Parliament. A Quarterly Report Guideline has also been prepared. The Quarterly Narrative Report contributes to the Half Yearly Report. The two reports (Quarterly and Half Yearly) basically form the heart of what is eventually the Annual Report, hence these are early indicators of policy implementation and Business Plan operationalisation progress. DSPPAC Sector Analysts will use the Quarterly Report and Half Yearly Report as the core part of their analysis for the Ministerial Budget Committee (MBC) of compliant utilisation of Budget Appropriations and progress against Business and Corporate Plans.

It is noted that the Half Yearly Report reports against the approved Business Plan of each Ministry. The Half Yearly Report also provides specific detail on progress made in the period January to June annually against Ministry's Annual Development Report (ADR) targets to progress the delivery of the National Sustainable Development Plan as well as progress against disaster recovery initiatives, decentralisation and specific details provided on achievement of Budget Narrative targets, NPP funding usage and allocated projects under the Government Investment Plan (GIP).

The revised Guidelines have been developed to assist Director Generals and the Departments and agencies of each Ministry to meet these responsibilities proscribed by the Public Service Act and the recent review of the Public Finance and Economic Management (PFEM) Act. The revision of the PFEM Act, mandating a 5 year planning framework for Corporate Plans has provided an opportunity to address amendments to the Corporate Planning Guidelines and therefore in turn to clarify the inter-related format of Annual Reports, Quarterly Reports and Half Yearly Reports.



Simil Johnson
Chair,
Public Service Commission
2021



GLOSSARY OF TERMS USED IN GUIDELINES

Term	Definition
Activities	Activities are aligned within the Programs (specified in Budget Narratives) of the Ministry to deliver the objectives of Ministry Programs. Activities should be developed, bearing in mind the challenges identified to ensure delivery strategies can be implemented. Furthermore, the activities in the Corporate Plans should not only be informed by the NSDP goals and objectives but also by any other strategic policy documents that are relevant to those areas being planned, including any Sector Plans or Recovery Strategies that may be in place.
Objectives	Objectives in the Corporate Plan are the over-arching organisational goals to be reached within the main program areas of activity of the Ministry. They should derive more or less directly from the NSDP, as expressed in the Budget Narratives. They express the expected outcomes (changes in the life of the target population) of the Ministry's endeavour. These objectives will be the same objectives as appear in the Budget Narrative.
Outcome	An Outcome can be expressed as a change in skills, attitudes, knowledge, behaviours, status, or condition, including life condition. An outcome is a long term Impact Indicator. In the Vanuatu Government, outcomes are linked to the NSDP and objectives and are mapped against the Programs.
Output	Outputs (Service Targets/Indicators) are mapped against each Activity included in the Budget Narratives. In aligning targets to outcomes, Ministry planners will start with the baseline target level and project the desired level of improvement (taking into consideration available resources over a specific time period).
Program	A Program establishes the structure for internal responsibilities while providing clear line of sight regarding Ministry objectives. Programs have a broad focus, with most ministries developing at least two and most likely, no more than six strategic programs for the Corporate Plan. The identified Programs form the basis of the Budget Narratives against which the Appropriations Budget is allocated.
Risks	A risk is a factor that may make it difficult to achieve delivery of a planned activity. Options should be considered to lessen or mitigate against an identified risk
Service Targets	Service Targets or outputs are mapped against each Budget Narrative Activity. In aligning targets to outcomes, Ministry planners start with the baseline target level, and project the desired level of improvement (taking into consideration available resources over a specific time period). The Service Target indicates what the program will produce, with the resources provided to meet the identified need which the objectives are intended to address. Specific targets are expressed to measure results.
Strategic Direction	The Strategic Direction (often referred to as a Strategic Objective) of the Ministry includes the central forces that move the Ministry towards intended objectives, in particular the NSDP. This aligns the vision, mission, and core values so that strategies can be designed to reach the desired goal outcomes.
Strategy	A strategy is a plan or tactic to be followed to achieve objectives and related activities, considering resources needed and the potential risks.
SMART Indicators	A SMART indicator or target is: Specific – clearly defined to anyone that has a basic knowledge of the project, program or policy. Measurable – to be counted, observed, analysed, tested or challenged. Achievable – is practical and can be done in time & with available resources – not too ambitious Relevant – contributes to the value of the activity Time-Bound – has clear dates for implementation/completion

Contents

Foreword	2
GLOSSARY OF TERMS USED IN GUIDELINES	1
Contents	2
Purpose of Half Yearly Reports.....	3
Half Yearly Report Guidelines and Process.....	3
Timing & Recipients	3
Items to include in Half Yearly Report.....	3
Director General's Statement.....	3
Overview for the Six Months January to June	4
Human Resources	4
Financial Statements	5
Development Projects	5
Capital Expenditure	5
COM Decisions.....	5
Assistance	5

Purpose of Half Yearly Reports

The Half Yearly Report of Government Ministries is a functional document designed to inform the Government, the Parliament and the people of Vanuatu what the organisation has been doing and has achieved over the period January to June annually.

A Half Yearly Report is required to track delivery, identify slippage due to emerging priorities such as a national disaster and to allow for review of Business Plans.

The Half Yearly Report is submitted to Sector Analysts and the Monitoring and Evaluation Unit of the Department of Sectoral Policy, Planning & Aid Coordination (DSPPAC). It should be noted that in addition, DSPPAC requests each Ministry to provide a quarterly narrative report (Quarterly Report) against the Budget Appropriations and Program Narratives as presented to Parliament. These two reports basically form the heart of what is eventually the Annual Report, hence are early indicators of policy progress or challenges needing to be addressed.

These Reports are what DSPPAC Sector Analysts use as the core part of their analysis for the Ministerial Budget Committee (MBC) along with New Policy Projects (NPP's) and demonstrate the Ministry performance to date.

It is noted that the Half Yearly Report reports against the approved Business Plan of each Ministry. In addition, the Half Yearly Report provides specific detail on progress made in the period January to June annually against Ministry's Annual Development Report (ADR) targets to progress the delivery of the National Sustainable Development Plan and as well, progress on any disaster recovery projects, decentralisation initiatives as well as specific details provided on achievement of Budget Narrative targets and allocated projects under the Government Investment Plan (GIP).

Half Yearly Report Guidelines and Process

The Half Yearly Report should be concise and direct. Paragraphs should be kept reasonably short. The narrative description in the Overview of the Report should be no more than 5 pages. The Report is a progress and issues document. To ensure the accuracy and timeliness of preparing reports, Director Generals may consider nominating an officer such as the Executive Officer to coordinate the preparation of the report on behalf of the entire Ministry.

Furthermore, relevant content for the Report should be captured throughout the six months January to June as issues occur. For example, Director Generals may introduce a standing item at monthly meetings with Directors, as required by Public Service Instruction No. 1 of 1999, in which each Director lists activities occurring in their respective Department/Unit over the preceding month, highlighting achievements, progress made against performance measures determined in the Business Plan, any difficulties experienced and proposed solutions. Such reports could be amalgamated for use in the Half Yearly Report.

Timing & Recipients

The Report must be furnished by the Director General to DSPPAC by 31st July each year. At the same time a copy should also be provided to the Public Service Commission.

Items to include in Half Yearly Report

Director General's Statement

The Half Yearly Report should contain a very brief introduction to the Report and a statement by the Director General outlining achievements, challenges, identification of any emerging issues leading to delivery of the Business Plan and activities defined in the Budget Narratives. A tabular presentation may be effective.

Overview for the Six Months January to June

The Half Yearly Report should contain a statement of the Ministry's progress against the Business Plan Objectives.

1. Report Against Relevant Business Plan Objectives

The Half Yearly Report should spell out each objective listed in the Ministry's Business Plan for delivery in that reporting year and then explain the achievements, progress made and/or difficulties experienced against each objective. *A tabular presentation can be used.* This should set out:

- a) The main activities of the Ministry and the services that have been provided in the six months January to June including any data on the use of services and impact— particularly in the Provinces;
- b) Service Delivery is a significant issue and issues such as increased access to services (including planned decentralisation initiatives in the provinces) and performance improvement achieved need to be highlighted;
- c) Progress against issues identified in the Quarterly Report and recommendations for ways forward to mitigate risks, strengthen current achievements and re-set proposed delivery/activity schedules.

This will be analysed by Sector Analysts (DSPPAC) and presented to the OPSC. This will considerably assist the Performance Improvement Unit (PIU) in the OPSC with performance assessment at organisational levels.

2. Report Against Annual Development Report (ADR) Targets:

Achievement by the agencies of the Ministry proscribed in the Annual Development Report against the targets of the National Sustainable Development Plan (NSDP);

3. Report Against Ministry Budget Narrative

Performance measures listed in the Ministry Budget Narrative should be specifically referred to, including progress achieved against each;

4. Policy Development

Any new policies that have been formulated by the Ministry. This can usefully be provided in tabular form, indicating Implementation Plans development and other Ministries and agencies partnering the policy delivery.

5. Portfolio Legislative Framework

The Half Yearly Report should contain a list of any new legislation that has been passed by the Parliament legislation in the First Sitting (usually April annually) or parts of legislation during the year by the Minister. Any transfer of responsibility of legislation occurring should be specified.

6. Conventions

Any new Conventions agreed to in the six monthly reporting period for which the Ministry is responsible or contributes to should be added to a table of existing Conventions. Provide in a tabular form indicating ratification status and implementation progress;

Human Resources

Staffing information in Half Yearly Report should include data such as:

- the total number of permanent employees, disaggregated by sex and language group;
- full-time, probationary, contract and daily-rated staff numbers, disaggregated by sex and language group;
- retirements in the period;
- redundancies (if any) in the period;

- Leave Accrual Analysis;
- scholarships (area of study, subject, level disaggregated by sex and language group)
- training delivered January to June with a description of the training being undertaken broken down into area of study, subject, recipients, delivery agency.

Financial Statements

The Half Yearly Report should contain financial reporting on utilisation of budget allocations and delivery of the activities defined in the Budget Narratives.

Reports producing these statements are set up on the FMIS. Whoever coordinates the Half Yearly Report i.e. the Executive Officer (EO) working with the Ministry senior financial officer (Finance Manager and/or Finance Officer) should liaise with MFEM to access these statements for inclusion in the Half Yearly Report.

Vision Reports by Program and Activity for the Ministry Agencies can be drawn from MFEM's FMIS on request from the Ministry's Finance Manager/Finance Officer.

Development Projects

The Half Yearly Report should list and describe the activities of any technical assistance attached to the Ministry and all major development projects carried out during the year. A tabular format is recommended.

Capital Expenditure

Whilst the Ministry for Infrastructure reports on capital works expenditure, the Half Yearly Report should include brief information about each major approved capital item, including vehicles, acquired by the Ministry and its Departments/Agencies.

COM Decisions

The Half Yearly Report should also be used to inform the Government of Vanuatu on implementation progress of the decisions made by the Council of Ministers during the reporting period as well as the implementation of previous decisions that may be still be being completed during this period.

Assistance

For questions and suggestions regarding these Guidelines and for any assistance in the preparation of reports, contact the Manager, Corporate Services Unit (CSU) OR Manager, Performance Improvement Unit (PIU) within the Public Service Commission.

Template 1: Half Year Report Against Budget Narrative

Department	47									
Program	Outcome Indicator	Output or Service Target	Performance to date	Activity	Performance Indicator	Target	Performance to date	Comment	Link to NRS	Link to NSDP
Increase market and commodity production	Kava production increased	YY tonnes per year	ZZ tonnes by July	47BA	No of nursery nurseries established/upgraded	6	3	On track	RO 2.2.2 Evidence of government and donor support appropriated through the Parliament and GIPs to support productive sectors Budget Narrative aligned to Business Plan indicating support to various sectors-formal and informal for 2020 onwards	ECO1.7.1 Level of production of major commodities to include cocoa and copra
				47BB	No of noble kava seedlings and cuttings	300,000	100,000	Complete		
				47BC	No of seedlings distributed	300,000	25,000	Behind schedule due to heavy rain in February		

Template 2: Report Against Development Project Implementation

Project Code	Description	Project Actual Start Date	Project Actual End Date	Donor	Total Budget Received from Donor	Total Spending to Date	Status*	Progress during half year	Issues, challenges and responses

*Status can be ongoing, not started, complete or delayed.

Template 3: Report on Progress Against COM Decision

COM Decision No	Date	Decisions to be implemented	Progress to date	Issues and challenges	Response to challenges